

Huntington 1968 RG Notes

Huntington, Samuel P. *Political Order in Changing Societies*.

New Haven: Yale University Press, 1968.

1 General Notes

- Social and economic development preclude political development: just having economic growth does not improve political outcomes unless institutions are also formed to shape item
- When social structures are strong or homogenous, they may take the form of political institutions – but, in their absence (or when there are many), we need political institutions to effectively coerce government
- Madison Federalist 51: “In framing a government which is to be administered by men over men, the great difficulty lies in this: you must first enable the government to control the governed; and in the next place oblige it to control itself.”
- Mature institutions have their own goals, incentives, traditions, etc. – they no longer simply serve those who created them, but they further serve themselves
- Argues that what is good for institutions is usually good for the country and is in some way a representation of the “public good” – that institutional strength is commensurate with effective governance
 - Subclaim: governments are “good” when their actions reflect the desires/goals of their institutions. *Alignment between institutions and their leaders/operators*

2 Important Specific Factual Claims

- Communist governments are highly effective at governing and establishing legitimate authority: “Men may, of course, have order without liberty, but they cannot have liberty without order. Authority has to exist before it can be limited, and it is authority that is in scarce supply...”